

Car CO2 standard negotiations restart

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【要点】

- ・ EU自動車メーカーのCO2排出基準に関する交渉が本日再開され、環境作業部会が目標について議論する予定である。
- ・ 燃料価格上昇により消費者がガソリン車から電気自動車へシフトしており、電気自動車の方がエネルギーコストが12~16%低いという報告がある。
- ・ EUは気候政策を単なる環境対策ではなく、産業政策と競争力強化の手段として位置付けることで、脱炭素化を産業の現代化と結びつけようとしている。
- ・ アイルランドの議長国は委員会の排出削減計画を支持しながらも、政治的・地政学的配慮により実装が難しいことを認めている。
- ・ 極右政党の台頭と気候政策への攻撃が、エネルギー転換政策を巡る政治的対立を深刻化させている。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By JORDYN DAHL with MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — Negotiations over the emission s

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By JORDYN DAHL

with MARTINA SAPIO

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SNEAK PEEK

— Negotiations over the emission standards that automakers must reach or face fines restart today with the environment working group meeting.

— Brussels is preparing to pull substantially more aviation and maritime emissions into the EU carbon market.

— Airlines are calling on the Commission to extend the temporary suspension mechanism for the new entry and exit system.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

CO2 STANDARDS TALKS: The EU institutions are restarting their negotiations for CO2 standards for automakers today with the environment working group meeting to discuss the targets. Kurt Vandenberghe, director general of DG CLIMA, urged policymakers not to further weaken the standards. “We should not cling to a nostalgia for the past that may have been very profitable but will lead to deindustrialization and bankruptcy if we cling to,” he said at an International Council for Clean Transportation event.

All about the €€: More consumers are trading in their combustion engine cars for electric vehicles thanks to higher fuel prices caused by the war in Iran. At the start of this year, the energy costs of combustion engine cars were 12 percent to 16 percent higher than for electric vehicles, according to a new report from the ICCT presented at the event.

Climate policy = industrial policy: The Commission is trying to change the narrative about climate policy, connecting it more directly to industrial policy and competitiveness rather than making it strictly about lowering emissions. “We don’t do it for protecting the planet. We do climate policy for protecting society and its economy,” Vandenberghe told attendees. “Decarbonization is about modernization.”

Not alone: Renew MEP Sigrid Friis made a similar argument at the event, saying: “I find it difficult to see how Europe could become more competitive by slowing down our own transition.”

Political considerations: The Irish Council presidency backed EVs and sticking with the Commission’s emissions-cutting plans, while acknowledging that politics and geopolitical considerations make that difficult. “We must ground policymaking in the best scientific analysis,” said John Martin, Ireland’s head of climate governance.

Culture wars: Although speakers didn’t discuss Germany’s weekend election that saw the far-right Alternative for Germany win in the state of Saxony Anhalt, the result and far-right attacks on climate policy to gain voters loomed over the conversations. “It’s as if this is becoming a culture war,” Vandenberghe said in his remarks.

Centrist compromise: MEP Luděk Niedermayer, with the European People’s Party, said he expects his group, which is leading negotiations in the European Parliament, to maintain a firewall against the far-right and reach a compromise solution with other parties. He noted, however, that his views aren’t in line with most of his EPP colleagues. (Read more on where the MEPs in ENVI and TRAN stand .)

GREEN TRANSPORT

ETS EXPANSION HITS PLANES AND SHIPS: Brussels is preparing to pull substantially more aviation and maritime emissions into the EU carbon market while recycling billions of euros back into cleaner fuels and propulsion, according to a Commission presentation to EU countries obtained by POLITICO.

Aviation first: The ETS would keep its current geographical scope — mainly intra-EEA flights plus routes to the U.K. and Switzerland — until the end of 2028, while adding flights between the EEA and Gibraltar and bringing more business aviation into the system.

But, but, but: From January 2029, the carbon price would extend to departing flights from Europe to third-country airports located within 5,000 kilometers of Frankfurt, which acts as the geographic center of the European Union, provided the route passes a 15,000-metric-ton annual emissions threshold. That would pull in destinations across North Africa, the Middle East, the Balkans and parts of Central Asia — including Turkey, Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Morocco and Egypt, while exempting least-developed countries and small island states.

Explainer: The Commission says the 5,000-kilometer rule is aimed at limiting “hub switching,” where passengers could be routed through nearby non-EU hubs to avoid the costs of the ETS or ReFuelEU Aviation rules.

Avoiding a double bill: On routes also covered by CORSIA, the global aviation offsetting scheme, airlines would be able to deduct eligible CORSIA costs from their EU ETS obligations. Brussels says the idea is to prevent airlines from paying twice for the same emissions; the Commission will publish price data needed to calculate the deduction. The arrangement would be reviewed by July 2032, when the Commission would decide whether to return to a narrower intra-European scope or move toward covering all departing flights.

More SAF cash: Aviation may also get another 110 million carbon allowances for sustainable aviation fuel support through 2040, on top of the current pot. The Commission estimates that could amount to around €15 billion between 2029 and 2040, compared with roughly €1.5 billion of support available under the current system through 2030.

Shipping next: The ETS would expand to thousands of smaller vessels from 2031, bringing selected ships between 400 and 5,000 gross tons into the carbon-pricing system. The categories include general cargo, offshore, oil, chemical, gas and LNG vessels, while smaller passenger and Ro-Pax ships would initially face emissions monitoring rather than full ETS payments.

By the numbers: The Commission estimates the extension would capture around 4,370 additional ships and about 9 million tons of CO₂, equivalent to roughly 10.6 percent of maritime emissions currently covered by the ETS baseline.

Clean-shipping cash: Maritime would receive its own 110-million-allowance support mechanism, also estimated at about €15 billion, for sustainable fuels and zero-emission propulsion technologies including electric and wind-assisted systems. The support is designed to narrow the cost gap between fossil marine fuels and cleaner alternatives and help shipowners meet FuelEU Maritime requirements.

No double paying: If the International Maritime Organization eventually agrees a global carbon-pricing measure, Brussels says it would look at allowing shipowners to deduct emissions already paid for under the IMO system from their EU ETS bill — to avoid double payment.

****Join us online today, Sept. 8, at 4 p.m. CEST for an analysis of Germany's far right challenge.** POLITICO's James Angelos and Nette Nöstlinger will examine the AfD's historic result in Saxony-Anhalt, its path to power and what the election means for Chancellor Friedrich Merz's government. Register [here](#) .**

MARITIME

WAR REACHES THE MED: A sanctioned Russian cargo ship linked to Moscow's military logistics was reportedly hit by drones in the Mediterranean.

What happened: Ukrainian outlet United24 reported that the Lady Mariia was struck while sailing between Crete and Libya. Russian opposition journalist Alexander Nevzorov claimed the ship took 12 direct hits, but Ukrainian authorities have not confirmed involvement, and the attribution has not been independently verified.

The cargo: Nevzorov also claimed the vessel was carrying Iranian weapons and armored vehicles bound for Russia and that the drones were launched from Libyan territory. Neither claim has been

independently confirmed.

VOSTOK OIL GETS MOVING: Russia has finally begun shipping crude from its giant Vostok Oil project through the Arctic, after sanctions and a shortage of suitable ice-class vessels helped delay the project from its earlier timetable.

Why it matters: Moscow is now showing it can assemble enough Arctic-capable shipping capacity to start exports despite Western sanctions. The first cargo left Bukhta Sever on a Russian-built ice-class tanker. Vostok Oil could become one of the biggest new sources of tanker demand on the Northern Sea Route, requiring dozens of ice-class ships and pushing far more Russian oil east through the Arctic and Bering Strait.

CARS

VW OFFLOADS FACTORY: Volkswagen is selling its Osnabrück factory to the German state of Lower Saxony and financial investor Aurelius Capital to convert the manufacturing plant into a defense center as the EU continues its rearmament push. [Read more here](#) .

What about the workers: The plant employs 2,300 workers and the worker's union estimates that "more than 1,200 people now have a prospect for their future" at the new defense center, union boss Daniela Cavallo said in a statement. The union is "working on a solution" for the remaining jobs.

INDUSTRY MEETING ON CHINA: EU trade chief Maroš Šefčovič is expected to meet European CEOs on Sept. 18 to seek industry feedback on the European Commission's push to diversify critical supply chains away from China, four people familiar with the meeting told us. [Find out more here](#) .

AVIATION

AIRLINES WANT EES SUSPENSION CONTINUED: Irish airline Ryanair and aviation trade group IATA are calling on the Commission to extend permission for member countries to temporarily suspend the bloc's new Entry/Exit System. "The EU's handling of EES has been a shambles from start to finish," Ryanair COO Neal McMahon said in a statement .

Reminder: After a rocky rollout that saw lines for border checks extend up to six hours, the Commission rolled out a flexibility system that allowed member countries to temporarily suspend EES when the system was overloaded. The flexibilities expired on Sunday.

The asks: Ryanair wants the suspension mechanism extended until April. IATA's position is it should remain in place "until at least the end of the winter season and until the necessary operational conditions are in place," Thomas Reynaert, IATA's senior vice president for external affairs, said in an emailed statement.

PIT STOPS

A high-speed train between Cologne and Antwerp is now running with a stop at Brussels Airport.

Headlines

Here's a recap of yesterday's news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

EU trade chief to meet CEOs over China strategy

The gathering is set to bring together top execs from Europe's machinery, auto, electronics and chemicals industries.

By Camille Gijs, Jacopo Barigazzi, Carlo Martuscelli, Jordyn Dahl · Sept 07, 2026, 06:16 pm
Europe/Brussels CEST

VW factory to be used for Israeli air defense system

By Jordyn Dahl, Chris Lunday, Romanus Otte · Sept 07, 2026, 03:36 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

EU already applying new merger rulebook, Ribera says

The Commission pioneered its approach to efficiencies with a joint venture between Airbus and Air France.

By Francesca Micheletti · Sept 07, 2026, 01:19 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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